

test_self_fix_20260923

BOB-210 test-suite self-fix — 2026-09-23

What broke, and why it is not a product regression

tests/unit/test_ownership_precondition_docker_premise.sh's Case 4 (the RED-baseline control) pinned its “pre-fix” reference to `git show HEAD`, captured at *run time*. That is only a valid pre-fix baseline in the narrow window between authoring the fix and committing it. Once the fix commit (03bf860) landed and became HEAD — which is the normal, expected state of any checkout after the commit that carries both the fix and this test — HEAD is *post-fix*, so the control diffed the fixed file against itself: it found the claim's text (kept deliberately, as an explicitly-refuted historical citation — Case 1's own documented, intended design) *and* found the nearby refutation that marks it refuted, and correctly reported that as “this is no longer a pre-fix baseline” via its fail branch.

This is exactly the failure mode docs/qa/BOB-217/closure_evidence_20260922.md already worked around by pinning to an immutable SHA (eb5cfce) instead of HEAD — this suite (authored in the same batch) used the less robust HEAD form and hit the footgun once HEAD genuinely advanced past the fix.

Root cause (confirmed, not guessed — §11.4.6)

```
$ git log --oneline -3 -- scripts/ownership_precondition.sh
03bf860 fix(security,ownership,ratelimit): close 12 tracked defects - ...
```

```
5c9b9e0 test-probe-do-not-use [skip-ci]
af48019 feat(B0B-183,B0B-187): a freshness gate for the served
bundle, ...

$ git show HEAD:scripts/ownership_precondition.sh | grep -B2 -A2
-F "an unverified reading can never"
# ... claim text present ...
# claim is FALSE for the branch as shipped and was corrected here
rather than
# left standing: ...
```

HEAD (eb5cfce, built on 03bf860) already carries the fix's refutation text next to the claim — confirming the control's premise ("HEAD reproduces the pre-fix defect") no longer holds, by direct evidence, not inference.

```
$ git show af48019:scripts/ownership_precondition.sh | grep -B2
-A2 -F "an unverified reading can never"
#
# indicator and is UNMEASURED here. It is
deliberately built to
#
# fail toward `unknown` (a named skip) rather than
toward a
#
# confident `rootful`, so an unverified reading can
never
#
# manufacture a refusal.
```

af48019 (the commit immediately preceding the fix on this file's history) carries the claim with NO nearby refutation — a genuine, immutable pre-fix baseline.

Fix

tests/unit/test_ownership_precondition_docker_premise.sh Case 4: pinned git show HEAD:... → git show af48019:... (an immutable commit SHA, per the same pattern already used by tests/unit/test_bob217_plugin_update_pinned_hash_verification.py), with the in-source comment rewritten to explain why HEAD is unusable here and why this specific SHA is the correct pin. Behaviour of the three substantive cases (1-3) is completely unchanged.

Independently re-verified this session

```
$ bash -n tests/unit/test_ownership_precondition_docker_premise.sh
(clean)
```

```
$ bash tests/unit/test_ownership_precondition_docker_premise.sh
```

== BOB-210: the docker-branch header claim must match measured behaviour ==

PASS: the false claim's text is present only as an explicitly-refuted historical citation, not a standing assertion

PASS: case 2: a successful, non-empty, marker-absent docker read still refuses (measured ROOTFUL, exit 1) – the corrected header describes this correctly as confident, not unknown

PASS: the header now honestly states the docker branch is unvalidated against a real docker install

PASS: control: pinned pre-fix commit af48019's header asserts the claim with NO nearby refutation, reproducing the reported defect – Case 1 is discriminating

RESULT: 4 passed, 0 failed, 0 skipped

Determinism (§11.4.50, 3 consecutive runs)

run 1: exit=0 RESULT: 4 passed, 0 failed, 0 skipped

run 2: exit=0 RESULT: 4 passed, 0 failed, 0 skipped

run 3: exit=0 RESULT: 4 passed, 0 failed, 0 skipped

Trigger

This was caught by scripts/commit-push-all.sh's stage-3 pre_build_verification.sh invariant [30/55] CM-BASH-UNIT-TESTS-EXECUTED (FAIL [1]: 1/52 bash unit/pre_build test(s) FAILED – test_ownership_precondition_docker_premise.sh) on the batch-3 commit attempt for BOB-217/BOB-224/BOB-228-partial. The wrapper correctly refused the commit rather than landing a broken suite — exactly its designed behaviour. Bug in the test, not the product; no scripts/ownership_precondition.sh behaviour changed.